We can align the Movie Trends data product with the marketing BI tool, and the Financial Analysis/Reporting data product with the financial BI tool. This heuristic applies if the BI tool, dashboard, or visualization serves a single purpose or similar purposes. However, you need to be careful not to align data products with a tool used by tens of actors with tens of various goals in mind. Otherwise, you may end up with a canonical model in a centralized data warehouse, losing all the advantages of the data mesh.

Build the data product as a registry for a core business entity

Another way to define a data domain is to look at core physical entities used by various levels of your business. An example of such a data domain could be Customer 360, which describes the physical entity of each customer.

However, you need to be highly cautious when defining boundaries by using this heuristic. It often leads to centralized data warehouse solutions. In the case of Messflix, we could think about tracking the subscriber or customer life cycle in such a data domain. Such a domain could also be responsible for taking care of global identity and deduplicating two entities with the same identity. So you should consider it: if identification, deduplication, or consistency across the organization are crucial concerns, you could consider this heuristic. In other cases, it’s probably not the best approach.

Create a data product for a cohesive group of domain datasets

Domain datasets stored in a data product should form a cohesive model. Therefore, whenever you notice that some datasets in the data product are not related, it is a sign that you should think about dividing the data product into smaller pieces.

A good example is a data product that stores aggregated financial data and, at the same time, customer 360–type of data. In such cases, we can’t refer to a specific customer in aggregated financial data, and there is no shared business goal. Therefore, we should avoid such a situation.

At the same time, we should also avoid creating data products for just a part of the domain dataset. Domain datasets, by our definition, are the most granular datasets that still have a business value of their own. Dividing data